

Internet & SaaS (ZIA)

Configuring the Malware Protection Policy

■ Watch a video about configuring the Malware Protection policy (shows Legacy UI).

The Zscaler service uses an industry-leading AV vendor for signature-based detection and protection so it can provide comprehensive web security. In addition to virus and spyware protection, the service uses malware feeds from its trusted partners, such as Microsoft and Adobe, as well as its own technologies to detect and block malware. You can capture and store traffic that is allowed or blocked by this policy as PCAP files. To learn more, see [About Traffic Capture Settings](#). The Malware policy applies globally to all an organization's locations.

You can also configure exceptions to the Malware Protection policy. To learn more, see [Configuring Security Exceptions for the Malware Protection Policy](#). Zscaler also has a [recommended policy](#) for Malware Protection.

To learn how this policy fits into the overall order of policy enforcement, see [About Policy Enforcement](#).

Configuring the Malware Protection Policy



Zscaler recommends that you don't change the default settings of the Malware Protection policy to ensure the security of your user traffic.

To configure the Malware Protection policy:

1. Go to **Policies > Cybersecurity > Malware Protection**.
2. On the **Malware Policy** tab:
 - **Inspect Inbound Traffic:** Enable the Zscaler service to scan internet traffic coming into your network for malicious content. It scans traffic for all protocols you've enabled below and scans all files, including those with up to 5 layers of recursive compression.
 - **Inspect Outbound Traffic:** Enable the Zscaler service to scan outgoing internet traffic for malicious content. It scans traffic for all protocols you've enabled below and scans all files, including those with up to 5 layers of recursive compression.
 - **Inspect HTTP:** Enable the Zscaler service to scan HTTP traffic (and HTTPS traffic if [SSL Inspection](#) is enabled) in real time. The **Inspect Inbound/Outbound Traffic** options above determine whether inbound, outbound, or both types of traffic are scanned. The service scans all files, including those with up to 5 layers of recursive compression.

- **Inspect FTP over HTTP:** Enable the Zscaler service to scan FTP over HTTP traffic in real time. The preceding **Inspect Inbound/Outbound Traffic** options above determine whether inbound, outbound, or both types of traffic are scanned. The service scans all files, including those with up to 5 layers of recursive compression.
- **Inspect FTP:** Enable the Zscaler service to scan FTP traffic in real time. The **Inspect Inbound/Outbound Traffic** options above determine whether inbound, outbound, or both types of traffic are scanned. The service scans all files, including those with up to 5 layers of recursive compression.



Zscaler offers FTP traffic inspection as part of the FTP Control policy. To learn more, see [Configuring the FTP Control Policy](#).

- **Unwanted Applications:** **Allow** or **Block** unwanted files that are also downloaded when users download a program they want.
- **Trojans:** **Allow** or **Block** malicious programs that are presented as beneficial or useful.
- **Worms:** **Allow** or **Block** malicious programs that duplicate themselves to spread malicious code to other devices.
- **Ransomware:** **Allow** or **Block** malicious programs that can encrypt files and prevent users from accessing their devices, files, or data until a ransom payment is made.
- **Remote Access Tool:** **Allow** or **Block** downloads from tools that are common from remote access sites.
- **Other Viruses:** **Allow** or **Block** malicious programs that cause damage to systems and data. This category refers to any viruses that don't fit into the more specific malware categories. The Zscaler service detects other viruses through file reputation or signature matching (e.g., antivirus).
- **Adware:** **Allow** or **Block** malicious files that automatically render advertisements and install adware.
- **Spyware:** **Allow** or **Block** malicious files that covertly gather information about a user or an organization.



If Traffic Capture is enabled, the **Capture** option appears when **Allow** or **Block** is selected. Captured traffic is stored in PCAP files for later analysis. To enable Traffic Capture for this policy, see [Configuring Traffic Capture Settings](#).

3. Click **Save** and [activate the change](#).